

Movie Scene 2: Late-Night Planning

Tom: Why are you still here? It's almost nine.

Dan: Headquarters changed the departure time.

Tom: Again?

Dan: Again.

Tom: How bad?

Dan: Six hours earlier.

Tom: You're joking.

Dan: I wish.

Tom: Did logistics approve that?

Dan: Not yet.

Tom: Then why are we changing everything?

Dan: Because if we wait for approval, we'll have three hours to reorganize two hundred people.

Tom: That's a good point.

Dan: I know.

Tom: What's the biggest problem?

Dan: Transportation.

Tom: Not communications?

Dan: Communications can adjust. Transportation can't magically create buses.

Tom: How many do we need?

Dan: Twelve.

Tom: How many do we have?

Dan: Nine.

Tom: That's not great.

Dan: No.

Tom: What are our options?

Dan: Split the movement into two waves or borrow vehicles from another unit.

Tom: The second option is better.

Dan: I agree.

Tom: Will they help?

Dan: Maybe.

Tom: That's military language for "probably not."

Dan: Exactly.

Tom: Remember last year's exercise?

Dan: Which disaster?

Tom: The one where everyone arrived three hours late.

Dan: That started with a fifteen-minute delay.

Tom: Amazing how small mistakes become big problems.

Dan: That's why I hate hearing people say planning is boring.

Tom: Nobody notices planning when it works.

Dan: And everyone notices when it doesn't.

Tom: So what's next?

Dan: We finish this schedule, call transportation, and hope somebody answers.

Tom: At nine at night?

Dan: We can dream.

Tom: You know, most people think military life is action movies.

Dan: Most people have never seen a planning spreadsheet.

Tom: Probably for the best.

Dan: Probably.